

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a health magazine:

EQ or IQ?

What is the difference between Intelligence Quotient (IQ) and Emotional Quotient (EQ)?

IQ is a measure of people's intelligence.

EQ is a measure of the ability of people to understand their own or other people's emotions and feelings.

Why is EQ important?

Emotional intelligence is claimed to be more important than traditional measures of intelligence such as IQ. Research shows that 85 percent of your financial success is due to EQ skills, your personality and ability to communicate, discuss, and lead. Surprisingly, only 15 percent is due to subject knowledge.

Why is low EQ a problem?

Many kids today are "emotionally unprepared" to compete in the work environment because of low EQ. Low EQ is linked to violence, drinking alcohol, drug use, obesity and unhappiness.

A survey found that more than half of American students experienced feelings of worry and anxiety, and about a third felt deep depression during the academic year. People with low EQ find it difficult to learn if they do not have the skills to handle their emotions and they don't feel safe and supported enough to talk to people around them.

Why might EQ be falling?

Children develop social and emotional skills through strong family and community links, as well as through free play with other children. But just as parents have become more protective and family size has fallen, then children's free time and face-to-face contact with others have also decreased.

You have been asked to give a presentation on developing younger students' EQ for the school's study support scheme. You are meeting to discuss the topic. You may want to talk about:

- what problems students face which affect their emotions
- why EQ is important
- ways your school can help students to develop emotional intelligence
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Who can you talk to when you have problems?
2. Do your friends discuss their problems with you?
3. Do you like to work in groups?
4. Do you agree that having a high IQ is important?
5. Which is more important: IQ or EQ?
6. How does a large family help develop EQ?
7. Do Hong Kong schools prepare students to have a high EQ?
8. Do you think all successful people have a high EQ?